

Hydra — Practical Tool Guide

Understand -l/-L, -p/-P, -s, -t, -V, -f, common SSH/FTP services, and the http-post-form syntax.

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Usage note: Password testing is noisy and can trigger account lockout. These examples assume accounts and services in an authorized lab.

SERVICE

Choose the service

CREDS

Choose user/list

RATE

Reduce threads

VERIFY

Confirm success

Contents

1. General syntax
2. Common service examples
3. HTTP login form
4. Troubleshooting results
5. Safer lab workflow

1. General syntax

Hydra does not guess the service automatically. Provide credential sources, target, and service.

GENERAL

```
hydra [LOGIN_OPTIONS] [PASSWORD_OPTIONS] [TARGET] [SERVICE] [SERVICE_OPTIONS]
```

Option	Meaning	Use
-l USER	One username	When the username is known.
-L FILE	Username list	When multiple authorized usernames are available.
-p PASS	One password	Test a specific credential.
-P FILE	Password list	Authorized password testing.
-s PORT	Non-default service port	For example SSH on 2222.
-t N	Parallel tasks	Reduce to limit load or lockout risk.
-V	Verbose per attempt	Useful for troubleshooting but very noisy.
-f	Stop after first success for a target	Reduces unnecessary attempts.
-S	SSL/TLS	For selected encrypted services.

2. Common service examples

Note: Use these only when password testing is explicitly in scope.

KALI TERMINAL — SSH, one user

```
hydra -l [USER] -P [WORDLIST] ssh://[TARGET] -t 4 -f
```

KALI TERMINAL — FTP, username list

```
hydra -L [USERLIST] -P [WORDLIST] ftp://[TARGET] -t 4
```

KALI TERMINAL — Non-standard port

```
hydra -l [USER] -P [WORDLIST] -s 2222 ssh://[TARGET] -t 4
```

3. HTTP login form

The key is knowing the field names and an unambiguous failure marker.

KALI TERMINAL — Read module help first

```
hydra -U http-post-form
```

KALI TERMINAL — POST form template

```
hydra -l [USER] -P [WORDLIST] [TARGET] http-post-form
"/login:username=^USER^&password=^PASS^:F=Invalid credentials"
```

Capture the request in Burp to learn the path and parameter names. Choose a clear failure marker such as F=... or the success marker format supported by the module.

Note: Login forms can lock accounts or trigger defenses. Use small lists and lab accounts only.

4. Troubleshooting results

If every attempt appears successful, or every attempt fails, the marker, protocol, or service options are usually wrong.

KALI TERMINAL — Verbose

```
hydra -V -l [USER] -P [WORDLIST] [TARGET] [SERVICE]
```

KALI TERMINAL — Module help

```
hydra -U [SERVICE]
```

For http-post-form, compare a known failed response and a known successful response manually in Burp before constructing the module string.

5. Safer lab workflow

Do not start automatically with rockyou.

Step	Action	Note
1	Identify service and port	Use Nmap.
2	Prove the login endpoint works	Manual login / Burp.
3	Choose one user or a small list	Based on lab evidence.
4	Reduce threads	Avoid lockout and noise.
5	Stop after success	Use -f when appropriate.
6	Verify manually	Use the credential once to prove it.

Prepared as a quick-reference companion to the canonical Arabic guide. Use only in labs or systems you are explicitly authorized to test.

References:

<https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra/blob/master/hydra.1>

<https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra/blob/master/hydra-http-form.c>